

SCHOOL OF LIFE FOUNDATION

# The Architecture of *Grace*

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## *Scenario Cards — Book 2*

Fifty-six discussion cards for Grades 3–5 — two per lesson across four units. Each card pairs a real classroom situation with discussion questions and, where relevant, a teacher note. Print, cut along the marked line, and laminate to reuse across classes and years.

# How to Use This Deck

56 scenario cards · Print · Cut · Laminate · Reuse

Each page contains two scenario cards for a single lesson, designed to be printed and cut along the marked cut line. Laminating the cards lets you reuse them across class periods and school years.

Each card carries **The Situation** (read aloud or displayed), **Discussion Questions** (to guide the conversation), and where relevant a **Teacher Note** (italicized — not read to students). Cards are also embedded in their lessons in the Teacher Master Document for reference during delivery.

Cards are color-coded by unit:

-  Unit 1 · Knowing & Accepting Yourself
-  Unit 2 · Self-Compassion & Self-Forgiveness
-  Unit 3 · Empathy & Forgiving Others
-  Unit 4 · Grace & Generosity

Risk-flagged lessons are marked in the Teacher Master Document — review the full Safety Check protocols there before delivering those lessons.

## I-A

UNIT 1 · AUG-OCT

### WHO AM I?

#### THE SITUATION

Marcus shared on his identity web that he loves drawing comics. A classmate said, "That's babyish." Marcus feels embarrassed and wishes he had said something else.

#### DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- › Is Marcus's love of comics part of who he truly is?
- › Why does a classmate's comment make him want to hide it?
- › What is the difference between something being part of your identity and something being "cool" according to others?
- › What would you say to Marcus to help him hold his identity with confidence?

✂ CUT HERE

## I-B

UNIT 1 · AUG-OCT

### WHO AM I?

#### THE SITUATION

Amara is filling out her strengths inventory and cannot think of a single thing to write. She keeps crossing things out. "I'm not really good at anything," she tells her partner. Her partner looks surprised.

#### DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- › Why might Amara struggle to name her own strengths, even though others can see them?
- › What is the difference between a strength you were born with and one you developed through effort?
- › If you were Amara's partner, what specific strength might you have already noticed about her in just this one class?

## I-C

UNIT 1 · AUG-OCT

### EMOTIONS ARE INFORMATION

#### THE SITUATION

During a math test, Jayla's mind goes blank even though she studied. She feels a wave of panic. After the test: "I hate when that happens — my feelings always ruin everything."

#### DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- › What message was Jayla's panic actually trying to send her?
- › Is Jayla's emotion the problem — or is it a messenger pointing at a different problem?
- › If Jayla could name the emotion precisely, how might that help her next time?

✂ CUT HERE

## I-D

UNIT 1 · AUG-OCT

### EMOTIONS ARE INFORMATION

#### THE SITUATION

Deon gets in the car after school and says "Fine" when asked about his day — but he actually felt lonely, left out, and invisible. He didn't have words for it.

#### DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- › What emotions was Deon actually feeling?
- › Can you name them more precisely than "fine"?
- › What message were those emotions trying to carry?
- › Why might it be hard to share emotions, even when we do have words for them?

## I-E

UNIT 1 · AUG–OCT

### EVERYONE MAKES MISTAKES

#### THE SITUATION

Priya forgot her part of a group project. The group had to present without it and got a lower grade. That night, Priya kept repeating: "I always ruin everything. I am so irresponsible. I am a bad friend."

#### DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- › Which of Priya's self-statements are about the MISTAKE, and which are about her IDENTITY?
- › What is the difference between "I made an irresponsible choice" and "I am irresponsible"?

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**TEACHER NOTE** **INNER CRITIC** · *"I always ruin everything. I'm a terrible friend."* **INNER COACH** · *"I forgot something important. That hurt my team. I need to apologize and figure out how to be more reliable."*

✂ CUT HERE

## I-F

UNIT 1 · AUG–OCT

### EVERYONE MAKES MISTAKES

#### THE SITUATION

During soccer tryouts, Jaylen missed the winning penalty kick in front of everyone. His older brother says: "Messi missed penalty kicks. Jordan missed shots. That doesn't make you or them a bad player."

#### DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- › Is the missed kick evidence that Jaylen is a bad soccer player — or evidence that he is a soccer player?
- › Why do we hold onto our worst moments as if they define us?
- › What would you tell Jaylen to help him put the miss in its proper place?

## I-G

UNIT 1 · AUG-OCT

### INNER CRITIC VS. INNER COACH

#### THE SITUATION

Sofia just got her science test back — she failed. Her immediate thought: "See? I knew it. I'm just not smart. There's no point trying harder because I'm always going to fail."

#### DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- › Which voice is speaking — the Inner Critic or the Inner Coach?
- › Rewrite Sofia's inner monologue as if the Inner Coach were speaking.

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**TEACHER NOTE** **INNER CRITIC** · "I'm just not smart. There's no point trying." **INNER COACH** · "That didn't go the way I wanted. What did I not understand? I can figure out how to study differently."

✂ CUT HERE

## I-H

UNIT 1 · AUG-OCT

### INNER CRITIC VS. INNER COACH

#### THE SITUATION

During a class presentation, Theo's voice cracked and the class giggled. His inner voice said: "Everyone thinks I'm so weird. I'm never doing a presentation again."

#### DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- › What is the Inner Critic saying, and is it actually true?
- › How is the Inner Critic's advice making Theo's future worse?
- › What would the Inner Coach say instead?

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**TEACHER NOTE** **INNER CRITIC** · "Everyone thinks I'm weird. I'm never doing that again." **INNER COACH** · "That was embarrassing. Voices crack — it happens. I got through it, and next time will be easier."

## I-I

UNIT 1 · AUG-OCT

### GUILT VS. SHAME

#### THE SITUATION

Kenji told a secret his best friend had shared in confidence. When his friend found out, she was devastated. That night, Kenji felt terrible. He kept thinking: "I am such a bad person. A real friend would never do this. I don't deserve to have friends."

#### DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- › Is Kenji feeling guilt, shame, or both?
- › Which feelings are useful and pointing him toward repair?
- › What would a guilt response look like for Kenji — one that acknowledges the harm and moves toward making it right?

✕ CUT HERE

## I-J

UNIT 1 · AUG-OCT

### GUILT VS. SHAME

#### THE SITUATION

After getting a warning from the teacher for talking during quiet work time, Lily burst into tears and said, "I always get in trouble. I'm the worst student in this class. I can't do anything right."

#### DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- › What started as a behavior correction — what did Lily's mind turn it into?
- › What would a guilt response to getting a warning sound like?
- › If you were Lily's friend, what would you say to help her stay in guilt and out of shame?

I-K

UNIT 1 · AUG-OCT

## I AM MORE THAN MY WORST MOMENT

### THE SITUATION

Two years ago, Noah said something really cruel to a classmate who was crying. He apologized at the time. But now he thinks of himself as "the kind of person who is mean to people when they're sad."

### DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- › Is one moment two years ago enough evidence to conclude Noah is fundamentally a mean person?
- › What would it look like for Noah to hold that moment honestly without letting it be his whole story?

✂ CUT HERE

I-L

UNIT 1 · AUG-OCT

## I AM MORE THAN MY WORST MOMENT

### THE SITUATION

Chloe's parents divorced last year and she went through a period where she was really angry and mean to her friends. Some of those friends still see her as "the angry girl." She says, "Maybe they're right. Maybe that IS who I am."

### DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- › Is a difficult period in someone's life the same as their permanent identity?
- › What would you say to Chloe to help her distinguish between who she WAS in a hard season and who she IS now?

## I-G-REF

UNIT 1 · AUG–OCT

### UNIT 1 REFLECTION — AFFIRMATION CIRCLE

#### THE SITUATION

Each student receives an index card with a classmate's name. Write ONE specific, genuine affirmation — not "you are nice," but something specific you've genuinely noticed. Sentence frame: "Something I have noticed about you is \_\_\_\_."

#### DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- › What makes an affirmation genuine vs. generic?
- › How does it feel to name something real about a classmate?
- › Is it harder to give or receive a specific, sincere affirmation?
- › Teacher note: Every student must receive at least one card before the lesson closes.
- › No student leaves without their name being affirmed.

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## I-H-BRIDGE

UNIT 1 · AUG–OCT

### UNIT 1 → UNIT 2 BRIDGE

#### THE SITUATION

Look back at your Identity Web from Lesson 1. Choose one strength you wrote down. Now think of a time you made a mistake. Did your inner critic attack that strength — or did it attack your behavior?

#### DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- › What is the difference between the inner critic attacking your strength vs. your behavior?
- › That distinction is where Unit 2 begins.
- › In Unit 1 we learned who we are.
- › In Unit 2 we learn what to do when we let ourselves down.
- › Bridge Protocol: Use at the opening of Unit 2 Lesson 1 — 6–8 minutes.
- › Replaces the standard Opening Review.

## 2-A

UNIT 2 · OCT-DEC

### WHAT IS FORGIVENESS, REALLY?

#### THE SITUATION

After hurting her friend, Sofia cannot forgive herself. "Forgiving myself feels like I'm saying it was okay. And it wasn't okay. I was awful."

#### DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- › What is Sofia confusing forgiveness with?
- › What does self-forgiveness actually mean?
- › Does forgiving yourself require that what you did was acceptable?
- › Myth: "Self-forgiveness means what I did was okay." | Truth: Forgiving yourself means releasing the weight of it — not excusing the action.

✂ CUT HERE

## 2-B

UNIT 2 · OCT-DEC

### WHAT IS FORGIVENESS, REALLY?

#### THE SITUATION

Elijah got a two-day suspension eight months ago. He did everything required — apologized, served the suspension, made amends. But he still introduces himself as "the kid who got suspended."

#### DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- › What myth about forgiveness might Elijah be living out?
- › Why might someone hold onto a label even after they have done everything repair requires?

## 2-C

UNIT 2 · OCT-DEC

### THE WEIGHT OF SELF-CRITICISM

#### THE SITUATION

Nadia is a perfectionist. When she gets anything less than an A, she spends the day going over every mistake. She has trouble sleeping. Her teacher notices that Nadia erases more than she writes.

#### DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- › Where is Nadia's body carrying the weight of her self-criticism?
- › What "armor" has Nadia put on?
- › What is Nadia's Inner Critic saying behind all of this?
- › Body Check-In: Where do you feel tension when you are being hard on yourself?
- › Chest?
- › Stomach?
- › Shoulders?
- › Jaw?

✂ CUT HERE

## 2-D

UNIT 2 · OCT-DEC

### THE WEIGHT OF SELF-CRITICISM

#### THE SITUATION

After making a mistake during a group project presentation, Diego refused to speak for the rest of class. When asked what was wrong, he said "Nothing." His teacher noticed him pulling away from his friends at lunch too.

#### DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- › What behavioral signs suggest Diego is carrying significant self-criticism?
- › What does the self-criticism cost Diego beyond how he feels inside?

## 2-E

UNIT 2 · OCT-DEC

### ACCOUNTABILITY WITHOUT SELF-PUNISHMENT

#### THE SITUATION

Isabella accidentally broke her neighbor's prized garden gnome while playing. She told her parents and offered to pay for it with her allowance. But weeks later, she is still apologizing every time she sees the neighbor — even though the neighbor has clearly moved on.

#### DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- › Has Isabella done genuine accountability?
- › What did she do right?
- › At what point does accountability tip into self-punishment?
- › Three-Part Map: Broke the gnome ✓ Impact acknowledged ✓ Offered to pay ✓ COMPLETE.
- › The self-punishment can stop here.

✂ CUT HERE

## 2-F

UNIT 2 · OCT-DEC

### ACCOUNTABILITY WITHOUT SELF-PUNISHMENT

#### THE SITUATION

After lying to his parents about finishing his homework, Marcus got caught. He has been staying up late stressing, started triple-checking every assignment, and told his friend: "I am the worst kid. I always lie. I can't be trusted."

#### DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- › What accountability piece does Marcus need to complete?
- › Which parts of his response are useful?
- › Which parts are self-punishment rather than repair?

## 2-G

UNIT 2 · OCT-DEC

### TALKING TO YOURSELF KINDLY

#### THE SITUATION

After bombing a tryout for the school play, Zara's friend says: "If I had just bombed a tryout, here is what you would say to me: 'You are so brave for trying. One audition does not define you.' But you will never say that to yourself."

#### DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- › Why do we often speak to friends with more compassion than we speak to ourselves?
- › What does "honest AND kind" look like for Zara?
- › Write the self-compassion letter Zara's best friend might write to her.
- › Dr.
- › Neff: Self-kindness — treat yourself as you would treat a good friend.
- › Common humanity — everyone fails sometimes.
- › Mindfulness — acknowledge the pain without exaggerating it.

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## 2-H

UNIT 2 · OCT-DEC

### TALKING TO YOURSELF KINDLY

#### THE SITUATION

When Liam got a 68 on his math test, his mom said: "It is okay, sweetie. You tried your best. You are amazing no matter what." Liam felt worse, not better. He told his brother: "She's just saying that. That was a bad test."

#### DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- › Why did his mother's comfort not land?
- › What was missing from her response?
- › What is the difference between self-compassion and empty cheerleading?

## 2-I

UNIT 2 · OCT-DEC

### LETTING GO — A PRACTICE

#### THE SITUATION

Three months ago, Kayla cheated on a vocabulary quiz. She was so ashamed that she told her teacher the truth the next day and was given a zero. She did the right thing. But she still thinks about it almost every day.

#### DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- › Has Kayla done everything repair requires?
- › What is the difference between not forgetting something and being crushed by it indefinitely?
- › Acknowledge: Kayla cheated.
- › She told the truth ✓ Repair: Done ✓ Release: "I am choosing not to carry the weight of this the same way anymore."

✂ CUT HERE

## 2-J

UNIT 2 · OCT-DEC

### LETTING GO — A PRACTICE

#### THE SITUATION

Connor has tried to let go of crying in front of the whole class in third grade. He is in fifth grade now. He has put the stone down a dozen times in his mind. But sometimes it comes right back.

#### DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- › Has Connor failed because the shame keeps returning?
- › What is the difference between self-forgiveness as a one-time event and self-forgiveness as an ongoing practice?

## 2-K

UNIT 2 · OCT-DEC

### WHEN SELF-FORGIVENESS FEELS IMPOSSIBLE

#### THE SITUATION

Amara has never told anyone about the time she witnessed her best friend being bullied and did nothing. She walked away. Her friend moved schools shortly after. Amara has carried this for two years. She does not believe she deserves to feel better about it.

#### DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- › Is Amara's situation one where the classroom exercises alone are enough?
- › Who could be on Amara's support web?
- › What is the one sentence Amara could say to start a conversation with a trusted adult?
- › When to Ask for Help: The harm was significant · The person affected is no longer reachable · The weight has been carried too long.
- › Asking for help is wisdom — not weakness.

✂ CUT HERE

## 2-L

UNIT 2 · OCT-DEC

### WHEN SELF-FORGIVENESS FEELS IMPOSSIBLE

#### THE SITUATION

When Marcus's little sister fell off her bike while he was supposed to be watching her and got a small cut, he panicked and told his parents she fell on her own. Two years later, his sister is fine — but Marcus still lies awake thinking about the lie.

#### DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- › Why might Marcus feel this is "too small" to bring to an adult and "too big" to process alone?
- › What repair is still incomplete?
- › Who is on Marcus's support web?

## 2-LETTER

UNIT 2 · OCT-DEC

### UNIT 2 — LETTER TO FUTURE SELF

#### THE SITUATION

You are writing a letter to yourself to be opened in May at the year-end celebration. You are writing from what you know now — after seven weeks of Unit 2.

#### DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- › What is the most important thing you learned about being kind to yourself this unit?
- › What do you want your future self to remember about the work you did?
- › What would you say to your future self about the difference between accountability and self-punishment? ⚠

TEACHER: Collect every sealed envelope.

- › Label with student name.
- › Store securely.
- › Return at Unit 4, Lesson 7.
- › Do NOT lose these.

✂ CUT HERE

## 2-M-BRIDGE

UNIT 2 · OCT-DEC

### UNIT 2 → UNIT 3 BRIDGE

#### THE SITUATION

At the end of Unit 2 you wrote a letter to your future self. Now: Is there someone who hurt you that you've been carrying? Not a mistake you made — something they did. That is where Unit 3 starts. Your hurt is real.

#### DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- › In Unit 2 we practiced being kind to ourselves after mistakes.
- › In Unit 3 we turn that same compassion outward.
- › Unit 2 gave you the floor.
- › Unit 3 gives you the door.
- › What heavy thing did someone else put in your backpack?
- › Bridge Protocol: Use at the opening of Unit 3 Lesson 1 — 6–8 minutes.
- › Replaces the standard Opening Review.

### 3-A

UNIT 3 · JAN-MAR

#### YOUR HURT IS REAL AND IT MATTERS

##### THE SITUATION

Every day at lunch, a group of girls deliberately moves their chairs slightly so that Priya has to squeeze in awkwardly. No one says anything unkind out loud. When Priya mentioned it to her mom, her mom said, "They're probably not doing it on purpose. Just ignore it." Priya feels invisible and dismissed.

##### DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- › What kind of hurt is Priya experiencing, and is it real even if no one says anything unkind out loud?
- › What did Priya need from her mom that she did not receive?
- › What would validation have sounded like?
- › Before Forgiveness: This lesson does not ask students to forgive yet.
- › The one job right now: let the hurt be real.
- › Nothing more.

✂ CUT HERE

### 3-B

UNIT 3 · JAN-MAR

#### YOUR HURT IS REAL AND IT MATTERS

##### THE SITUATION

Two years ago, Marcus's best friend Jake stopped inviting him to things — no fight, no explanation. Marcus has moved on socially, but sometimes he still feels the ache of not knowing why. His dad says, "You're over it — you've got tons of friends." But Marcus is not fully over it.

##### DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- › Can you be "mostly over something" AND still carry a real hurt?
- › What does Marcus need acknowledged before he can genuinely let it go?

## 3-C

UNIT 3 · JAN-MAR

### WHY PEOPLE HURT PEOPLE

#### THE SITUATION

During a class presentation, Tyler made a joke at Samira's expense. The class laughed. Samira felt humiliated. When she told her older sister, her sister said: "He probably likes you." That made Samira feel worse.

#### DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- › Was the explanation Samira's sister offered helpful?
- › What is the difference between explaining why someone caused hurt and dismissing the hurt itself?
- › Intent vs.
- › Impact: Tyler may not have intended deep harm.
- › That does not make the impact less real.
- › Understanding is for the person who was hurt — not permission for the person who caused harm.

✂ CUT HERE

## 3-D

UNIT 3 · JAN-MAR

### WHY PEOPLE HURT PEOPLE

#### THE SITUATION

After being excluded from a group project by her friend group, Chloe's teacher explains that one of the girls has a difficult home situation and tends to act out when she is stressed. Chloe says: "So I have to just accept being treated badly because her home life is hard? That doesn't seem fair."

#### DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- › Is Chloe right?
- › Does understanding the reason make the treatment acceptable?
- › How would you explain to Chloe that understanding is for her benefit, not permission for the other person?

### 3-E

UNIT 3 · JAN-MAR

#### **FORGIVENESS IS NOT THE SAME AS TRUST**

##### **THE SITUATION**

After Jordan told Leila's secret, she apologized sincerely. Their teacher suggested they "make up and move forward." Leila says: "I can try to forgive Jordan. But I'm not going to tell Jordan secrets anymore." Jordan says that if Leila was really forgiving her, she would trust her again.

##### **DISCUSSION QUESTIONS**

- › Is Leila's position — forgiving without restoring full trust — reasonable?
- › What does Jordan misunderstand about what forgiveness requires?
- › FORGIVENESS — internal, for your own peace, requires nothing from Jordan. | TRUST — relational, must be rebuilt through demonstrated change over time, never obligatory.

✂ CUT HERE

### 3-F

UNIT 3 · JAN-MAR

#### **FORGIVENESS IS NOT THE SAME AS TRUST**

##### **THE SITUATION**

Nico was bullied by a group of kids throughout third grade. His current counselor encourages him to work toward forgiveness for his own peace. But his aunt keeps telling him: "You have to forgive AND forget."

##### **DISCUSSION QUESTIONS**

- › Is the advice to "forgive and forget" good advice?
- › Write the boundary statement Nico might say — honoring his forgiveness work AND his right to keep himself protected.

## 3-G

UNIT 3 · JAN-MAR

### **FORGIVENESS TAKES TIME**

#### **THE SITUATION**

Mia decided three months ago to forgive her friend Addy for spreading a rumor about her. She said the words. She meant it in the moment. But last week, she felt a sudden flash of anger — as real as the day it happened. "I thought I was done. I guess I'm not a forgiving person after all."

#### **DISCUSSION QUESTIONS**

- › Is Mia right that she is "not a forgiving person"?
- › What does the return of anger actually mean?
- › Where on the forgiveness path might Mia actually be?
- › Forgiveness Path: Still hurting → Beginning to understand → Some days are better → Choosing to put it down today → The hurt is getting smaller → I am okay.
- › Moving backward is not failure.

✂ CUT HERE

## 3-H

UNIT 3 · JAN-MAR

### **FORGIVENESS TAKES TIME**

#### **THE SITUATION**

Ben's best friend moved away in the middle of the year without saying goodbye. It has been eight months. Ben says: "I know he probably had no choice. But I'm still angry. I feel bad for being angry."

#### **DISCUSSION QUESTIONS**

- › Is Ben wrong to still feel angry eight months later?
- › How would you use the self-compassion from Unit 2 to respond to Ben's guilt about still feeling hurt?

### 3-I

UNIT 3 · JAN-MAR

#### HOLDING YOUR STORY WITHOUT BEING HELD BY IT

##### THE SITUATION

When Ava was seven, her family lost their home and had to move in with relatives for a year. She has told the story to herself as: "That was the year everything fell apart and I learned that nothing is safe." Now in fifth grade, she is cautious, guarded, and reluctant to trust.

##### DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- › Is the story Ava tells herself accurate — or is it one interpretation of what happened?
- › What is the story Ava might choose instead — one that honors the difficulty AND doesn't require her to live in fear?

✂ CUT HERE

### 3-J

UNIT 3 · JAN-MAR

#### HOLDING YOUR STORY WITHOUT BEING HELD BY IT

##### THE SITUATION

When Jordan's best friend group excluded him in fourth grade, he decided: "I'm clearly not the kind of person people want to be close to." He is now in fifth grade, has new friends, but the Panel 2 story is still running in the background.

##### DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- › What story is Jordan still telling himself from Panel 2?
- › Is that story true now?
- › How would you help Jordan write Panel 3?

## 3-K

UNIT 3 · JAN-MAR

### STORIES OF FORGIVENESS IN PRACTICE

#### THE SITUATION

After the class reads *Each Kindness*, one student says: "I feel bad for Chloe. But I also feel bad for Maya. Maya kept trying and Chloe kept saying no. Forgiveness doesn't seem to fix what happened between them."

#### DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- › The student is right: forgiveness does not fix what happened.
- › So what does it do?
- › What would you say to Maya if you were her friend?
- › *Each Kindness* explores regret, missed opportunity, and the cost of cruelty.
- › It does not offer easy resolution — because forgiveness in real life rarely does.

✂ CUT HERE

## 3-L

UNIT 3 · JAN-MAR

### UNIT 3 WRAP-UP — I CHOOSE

#### THE SITUATION

At the end of a role-play, Jasmine writes: "I choose not to forgive yet. Because I am still hurting. And that is where I am on the path." She is not sure if that is an acceptable answer.

#### DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- › Is Jasmine's "I Choose" statement valid?
- › Why might this be one of the most honest and healthy responses in the class?
- › All "I Choose" Statements Are Valid If Conscious: "I choose to forgive." ✓ "I choose to keep working at it." ✓ "I choose not to forgive yet." ✓

## 3-CHOOSE-A

UNIT 3 · JAN-MAR

### I CHOOSE — ROLE-PLAY A

#### THE SITUATION

Your classmate Kai teased you in front of the whole class in September. You confronted them. They apologized. It is now December. You still feel guarded around Kai. Someone asks: "Are you two good now?" Use all Unit 3 skills to respond.

#### DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- › Validate the hurt.
- › Explore why Kai might have done it.
- › Distinguish forgiveness from trust.
- › Where are you on the forgiveness path?
- › What is your "I Choose" statement?
- › All Unit 3 skills: Hurt is real · Why people hurt · Forgiveness ≠ Trust · Forgiveness takes time · Your story, your authorship · Say It Straight

✂ CUT HERE

## 3-CHOOSE-B

UNIT 3 · JAN-MAR

### I CHOOSE — ROLE-PLAY B

#### THE SITUATION

A friend group you used to belong to excluded you for three months in fourth grade. You have a new friend group now and are genuinely happy. But when you see the old group, you still feel a sting. Someone tells you: "You should be over it by now."

#### DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- › Is "you should be over it by now" a helpful thing to say?
- › What does the forgiveness path actually look like for this situation?
- › What is your "I Choose" statement?
- › Bridge Protocol note: After completing the I Choose exercise, transition directly into the Unit 3 → Unit 4 Bridge Protocol.

## 4-A

UNIT 4 · MAR–MAY

### WHAT DOES GRACE LOOK LIKE?

#### THE SITUATION

When Mateo transferred to a new school mid-year, he sat alone at lunch for three weeks. On the twenty-second day, a girl named Ryn moved her tray and said, "You can sit here." When asked what made her do it, Ryn shrugged: "Nobody should have to eat alone that long."

#### DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- › What makes Ryn's action an act of grace rather than just friendliness?
- › Mateo had done nothing to earn a place in the group.
- › Does grace require that someone deserve it?
- › Grace Defined: Giving something generous — kindness, a second chance, inclusion — to someone who has not necessarily earned it.
- › A choice, not a requirement.
- › A strength, not a weakness.

✂ CUT HERE

## 4-B

UNIT 4 · MAR–MAY

### WHAT DOES GRACE LOOK LIKE?

#### THE SITUATION

During a heated argument at recess, Omar said something cutting to his friend Darius. He meant it to sting — and it did. Afterward, he apologized sincerely. Darius was quiet for a moment, then said: "I know you were angry. We are still friends." He did not make Omar grovel.

#### DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- › What did Darius choose to give Omar that Omar had not yet earned back?
- › Grace is sometimes described as choosing the relationship over the wound.
- › What does that mean here?
- › Grace vs.
- › Doormat: Darius chose to extend grace — he was not forced to.
- › A doormat has no choice.
- › A person extending grace has full choice and chooses generosity deliberately.

## 4-C

UNIT 4 · MAR–MAY

### WHAT DOES MERCY LOOK LIKE?

#### THE SITUATION

After Priya was caught passing a note with an unkind comment about the substitute teacher, the sub read it out loud, then paused. "I have seen meaner notes in thirty years. I am not going to make this a bigger deal than it is. But think about how it would feel to read your name in someone's note." No referral. No call home. Priya thought about that comment for the rest of the week.

#### DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- › What consequence did the substitute teacher have the power to deliver — and what did she choose instead?
- › Why might the substitute's mercy have been more effective than a referral?
- › Mercy Defined: Choosing not to deliver the full consequence someone might deserve.
- › Research shows unexpected mercy often produces more genuine change than punishment.

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## 4-D

UNIT 4 · MAR–MAY

### WHAT DOES MERCY LOOK LIKE?

#### THE SITUATION

When Zach's group was assigned to clean up the science lab, he got distracted and left early without finishing. His lab partner Imani stayed and cleaned everything alone — again. When the teacher asked what happened, Imani said "We got it done." Zach said, "You covered for me. I owe you." She said, "Just don't leave me with it again."

#### DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- › What did Imani choose not to do — and what did that choice cost her?
- › How is what Imani did different from repeatedly covering for someone who takes advantage?

## 4-E

UNIT 4 · MAR–MAY

### GIVING THE BENEFIT OF THE DOUBT

#### THE SITUATION

Sofia sent a text to her friend group saying she couldn't come to the birthday gathering. Nobody responded. By the next morning, she had decided they were all angry at her, that she was being excluded from the group chat, and that the friendship was probably over. Two days later she found out the birthday girl's phone had died.

#### DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- › What interpretation did Sofia's brain offer first — and was it the most likely explanation?
- › Practice the Pause: What is another reasonable explanation for the silence besides rejection?
- › The Pause Practice: Step 1: Something ambiguous happens.
- › Step 2: Notice your brain's first interpretation.
- › Step 3: PAUSE — what is a reasonable charitable explanation?
- › Step 4: Act on it unless you have clear evidence otherwise.

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## 4-F

UNIT 4 · MAR–MAY

### GIVING THE BENEFIT OF THE DOUBT

#### THE SITUATION

Marcus walked past his classmate Deja without saying anything. Deja immediately thought: "He's still mad about what I said last week." In reality, Marcus hadn't slept and hadn't even noticed Deja. Meanwhile, Marcus's teammate Javi walked past without waving. Marcus thought: "Javi must be having a rough morning."

#### DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- › Marcus gave the benefit of the doubt to Javi but not to Deja.
- › What might explain the difference?
- › This is the in-group/out-group pattern.
- › What would it mean to apply the Pause Practice consistently?
- › In-Group / Out-Group: We automatically extend charitable interpretation to people we like.
- › Noticing where your CI runs out is where the real practice begins.

## 4-G

UNIT 4 · MAR–MAY

### SMALL ACTS, BIG DIFFERENCE

#### THE SITUATION

Ms. Abuelo made a point of learning every student's name by the second week and using it every single time she addressed them. At the end of the year, three different students independently listed "Ms. Abuelo knew my name" as one of the best things about the school year. One student wrote: "It sounds small, but it made me feel like I was a real person in this building."

#### DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- › What made Ms.
- › Abuelo's practice a micro-moment of grace rather than a grand gesture?
- › Research shows that frequency of kind acts matters more than size.
- › What is the difference between one large kind gesture and daily small ones?
- › The Compounding Effect: Small acts of grace, practiced consistently, compound.
- › Daily micro-moments create a relational culture.
- › Occasional grand gestures create memorable moments.
- › Both matter — but daily practice builds the foundation.

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## 4-H

UNIT 4 · MAR–MAY

### SMALL ACTS, BIG DIFFERENCE

#### THE SITUATION

When the class was assigned to work in groups, Jordan always ended up pairing with the same two friends. One day, without being asked, Jordan said: "Hey — Yara, do you want to be in our group?" Yara looked up, clearly surprised. The next week, Yara came back looking slightly lighter. Jordan had not thought about the ripple. The ripple happened anyway.

#### DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- › Jordan's act took approximately ten seconds.
- › What made it grace rather than just a practical decision?
- › Do micro-moments of grace require that you see the impact to be worth doing?

## 4-I

UNIT 4 · MAR–MAY

### GRACE WITH HARD PEOPLE

#### THE SITUATION

Everybody in the class knows that Brennan is prickly. He does not say thank you. He does not make eye contact. Most people have stopped trying. But Kiara has noticed something: Brennan always shows up. She has decided to keep treating him like he matters — not because he has been warm, but because she has decided that is who she wants to be.

#### DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- › Kiara is not extending grace because Brennan has earned it.
- › What is she basing her choice on?
- › What is the difference between Kiara's approach and putting up with mistreatment?
- › Internal Posture: Grace with hard people is often more internal than external.
- › It is choosing not to let someone's difficulty contaminate your own character.
- › Who you choose to be is not determined by how they choose to treat you.

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## 4-J

UNIT 4 · MAR–MAY

### GRACE WITH HARD PEOPLE

#### THE SITUATION

Every week at family dinner, Uncle Ray makes cutting comments about grades and choices. Nadia is tired of being the bigger person. But she has also noticed that when she reacts, dinner gets worse for everyone. She has started giving his questions the shortest true answer possible and not engaging further.

#### DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- › Is what Nadia is doing grace — or something else?
- › What word would you use for the choice she is making?
- › What is the line between grace with a difficult person and simply tolerating mistreatment indefinitely?
- › Difficult vs.
- › Unsafe: Difficult people are hard to be around.
- › Unsafe people cause genuine harm.
- › Grace is never an obligation to accept mistreatment.

## 4-K

UNIT 4 · MAR–MAY

### GRACE GAP FIELD ASSIGNMENT

#### THE SITUATION

During the Grace Audit, students in one class identified the same Grace Gap independently: the bench outside the gym where students who didn't make the team sat during tryouts. No one ever acknowledged them. One student, Amara, designed her micro-moment: on tryout days, she would walk past that bench and make eye contact with one person. Not pity — just acknowledgment. She did it for three weeks.

#### DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- › What is the Grace Gap Amara identified?
- › Amara's micro-moment took five seconds.
- › What made it meaningful?
- › She does not know the impact.
- › Does that uncertainty change whether it was worth doing?
- › The Grace Audit: A structured observation of your environment — looking for places where grace is noticeably absent.
- › Identify the gap.
- › Design the micro-moment.
- › Execute it.

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## 4-L

UNIT 4 · MAR–MAY

### GRACE GAP FIELD ASSIGNMENT

#### THE SITUATION

When the class shared their Grace Gap Field Assignment results, Theo reported that his micro-moment had not worked. He had chosen to say good morning to the custodian who cleaned his hallway every day. The first day, the custodian looked startled. The second day, she gave a short nod. By the end of the week, she had started waving first. "It worked," Theo said, confused. "But I thought it didn't." His teacher asked: "What did you think 'working' meant?"

#### DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- › What was Theo's definition of "working" — and how did his teacher's question challenge it?
- › What does Theo's story suggest about how we measure grace?
- › Measuring Grace: Grace is not measured by immediate visible impact.
- › It is measured by consistency, intention, and the character it builds in the person who chooses it.

## 4-M-CHARTER

UNIT 4 · MAR–MAY

### COMMUNITY CHARTER — WRITING GUIDE

#### THE SITUATION

Every person in this room contributes one commitment in their own voice. One thing you are choosing to carry into your future from this year. Charter language should be specific and true — not generic. "We will be kind" is not a charter commitment. "We will say something when we see someone left out" is a charter commitment.

#### DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- › What is ONE specific, true thing you are choosing to carry from this year?
- › How do you want to finish this sentence: "In this class, we chose to \_\_\_"?
- › What would a student reading this charter three years from now understand about who this class decided to be?
- › Teacher: Every student must contribute one line.
- › Every student must sign with a full signature — not initials.
- › Photograph the signed charter.
- › Share with families.

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## 4-N-LETTERS

UNIT 4 · MAR–MAY

### FUTURE-SELF LETTERS — RETURN PROTOCOL

#### THE SITUATION

These letters were written in December, sealed, and stored by your teacher. Today — in May — you are the person your December self wrote to. Open the letter. Read it silently. Give it three full minutes.

#### DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- › Who did you write to in December?
- › Who are you now in May?
- › What changed — and what stayed the same?
- › What would you write to your future self now, at the end of this year?
- › Teacher: Return sealed envelopes.
- › Allow 3 full minutes of silent reading before asking any questions.
- › This moment is one of the most powerful in the full curriculum.
- › Do not rush it.